

NAME: CHERYLACHIENG.

REGISTRATION NUMBER: C027-01-2630/2021

UNIT: CAPSTONE PROJECT

TITLE: STREET CHILDREN IN URBAN CENTRES

TASK: PHOTOGRAPHIC ESSAY

INTRODUCTION.

Street children remain one of the most visible yet vulnerable groups in many African urban centers. Rapid urbanization, poverty, family instability, and limited social protection systems have contributed to the growing number of children living and working on the streets. These children face daily challenges including hunger, lack of shelter, exposure to crime, exploitation, and limited access to education and healthcare.

This photographic essay documents the lived realities of street children in urban environments and reflects on the social, economic, and moral responsibilities of society in addressing this issue.

Photo 1: Children Sleeping in Open Spaces.



Children Engaged in Informal Labor.

Some street children engage in informal work such as collecting scrap metal, washing cars, or carrying goods. Although this demonstrates resilience and determination, it also represents child labor that deprives them of education and proper childhood development. Economic hardship often forces children into premature responsibility.

Photo 2: Informal Labor and Survival Activities.



Exposure to Substance Abuse.

Life on the streets exposes children to drugs and substance abuse as a coping mechanism against hunger, trauma, and stress. Substance use further worsens their physical and mental health and increases vulnerability to criminal networks. This cycle makes rehabilitation more complex and highlights the urgent need for intervention programs.

Photo 3: Exposure to Substance Abuse.



Limited Access to Education and Community or NGO Support Initiatives

Education is a fundamental right and a key tool for breaking the cycle of poverty. However, many street children lack access to formal schooling due to financial constraints, lack of documentation, or unstable living conditions. Without education, their chances of long-term socio-economic improvement remain limited.

Various community groups and non-governmental organizations attempt to support street children by providing food, temporary shelter, counseling, and educational programs. These efforts demonstrate that collective action can create positive change. However, sustainable solutions require coordinated government policies and long-term social investment.

Photo 4: Limited Access to Education.



Resilience and Hope

Despite facing adversity, many street children display resilience and hope. Their strength and determination remind society of their potential if given proper support. Addressing their needs is not merely an act of charity but an investment in the future of the community.

Photo 5 Resilience and Hope



